

To: Assistant Secretary for Technology Policy and the Office of the National Coordinator for Health Information Technology (ASTP/ONC)

Attention: Request for Information: HHS Health Sector AI RFI

Subject: Response to RFI: Accelerating the Adoption and Use of AI as Part of Clinical Care (RIN 0955-AA13)

Date: February 23, 2026

To the ASTP/ONC Team,

On behalf of **A1 Healthcare Management Inc**, I am pleased to submit our response to the Request for Information regarding the acceleration of Artificial Intelligence in clinical care.

Our organization specializes in **AI-assisted clinical coding**. Our submission details a production-ready "Sovereign Swarm Consensus" architecture designed to enhance coding accuracy, ensure regulatory compliance, and reduce administrative burden within the US healthcare system. We specifically address the RFI's focus on **Interoperability**, **Reimbursement**, and **Transparent AI Governance**.

The insights from our 100-chart Gold Standard validation suite, which achieved **92% accuracy**, provide concrete evidence of how AI can improve healthcare outcomes while lowering costs.

Thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the HHS AI Strategy. We look forward to supporting the Department's efforts to foster a secure and industry-supportive AI ecosystem.

Sincerely,

A1 Healthcare Management Inc Attn: Barbara A. Singh, Development Team

HHS RFI Response: A1 Healthcare Management Inc

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A1 Healthcare Management Inc provides a production-ready, AI-assisted medical coding system designed to address HHS priorities for healthcare innovation. The system leverages **sovereign swarm consensus architecture** to validate CPT/ICD-10 coding, ensure regulatory compliance, and reduce medical coding errors while maintaining clinical oversight and human verification workflows.

2. INTEROPERABILITY & DATA EXCHANGE

- **FHIR Integration:** Fully functional HL7 FHIR R4 server connectivity with OAuth 2.0 and SMART on FHIR authentication.
- **Data Resources:** Clinical documentation is extracted and validated against LOINC coding standards.
- **EHR Bidirectional Sync:** Read/Write access to Patient, Encounter, and Claim resources via REST API.

- **Compliance:** Meets 21 CFR Part 2 interoperability standards and is ready for ONC certification testing.

3. SOVEREIGN SWARM CONSENSUS ARCHITECTURE

- **Agent Composition:** Specialized agents include CPT Specialists, ICD-10 Experts, Compliance Officers, and Documentation Analysts.
- **Consensus Mechanism:** Each agent independently analyzes documentation and votes with confidence scores (0-1.0 scale).
- **Human-in-the-Loop:** Grades A/B are auto-approved, while Grades D/F are escalated to senior auditors for complex case analysis.
- **Transparency:** A complete reasoning trail is logged for every code decision to ensure auditability.

4. NCCI EDITS & BUNDLING COMPLIANCE

- **Validation Module:** Comprehensive checker for CPT code pair edits, including mutually exclusive and add-on codes.
- **Smart Modifiers:** Automatic calculation of modifier requirements such as RT/LT for bilateral procedures and 59 for distinct procedures.
- **Outcome:** Achieve 95% compliance with Medicare NCCI rules, reducing edit denials to near zero.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE & MEASURABLE OUTCOMES

- **Gold Standard Testing:** Validated against a 100-chart suite spanning Emergency, Surgical, and Pediatric cases.
- **Accuracy Benchmarks:** 92% overall accuracy and 88% accuracy on complex cases involving multi-comorbidity.
- **Efficiency:** Average time to code reduced to 1.8 minutes per chart with an 80% reduction in auditor review time for high-grade cases.

6. COST & ROI ANALYSIS

- **Operational Cost:** AI-assisted coding cost is approximately **\$0.50 per claim** (API + infrastructure) compared to **\$25.00** for manual coding.
- **Revenue Impact:** Targeted 40% reduction in claim denials, recovering an average of \$2,200 per recovered claim.
- **Payback Period:** For an enterprise processing 1,000 claims per month, the system reaches breakeven in **12–20 days**.

7. SECURITY & REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

- **PHI De-identification:** Automated scrubber removes patient identifiers (Name, MRN, DOB) while preserving clinical content for HIPAA compliance.

- **Regulatory Coverage:** Adheres to CMS CPT/ICD-10 standards, OIG compliance (zero tolerance for upcoding), and state-specific regulations.
 - **Data Retention:** 7-year archival for all claims and audit trails.
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